

Verodus: what the firm actually is, how it makes money, and what to consider

Research summary and strategic analysis · 20 August 2026

Verodus is a small, live simulated evaluation firm with a working CRM, MT5/TradeHub stack, and unusually careful legal language for this industry. It is not a broker and not a capital allocator. Economics are evaluation fees plus tightly gated discretionary payouts. Scale is the constraint: about 3,000 users against a market where the top five firms take most of the flow. The scarce asset is labeled trader-behavior data. The risk is copy drift, entity inconsistency, and a Trustpilot claim that is not easy to verify independently.

Who Verodus actually is

Public identity: a simulated proprietary-trading evaluation firm at verodus.com. Traders pay a service fee, trade a market-referenced demo under published rules, and, if they qualify, can request performance rewards paid from Verodus's own resources. No client funds, no brokerage, no live order routing.

Legal entities named on the public site (they do not all match):

- Verodus L.L.C.-FZ — Terms of Service; Dubai / UAE governing law and courts.
- Verodus LLC — Privacy Policy data controller; Risk Disclosure.
- Verodus Capital Inc. — all registration fees and performance rewards. Terms state no payments are processed by or payable to the FZ entity.

That split is a standard free-zone plus payment-company pattern. It is also a diligence item: three names for one brand, no published free-zone (IFZA, Meydan, DMCC, etc.), no license number, no registered address on the pages reviewed. Kim Chen is listed as Co-Founder & CEO; Alexander Vladimirovich as Co-Founder & COO. Public bios beyond those titles were not found.

What it is not: not SFC/FCA/CFTC licensed, not a fund, not live prop capital. FAQ last updated 9 February 2026: Platform 5 (MT5) is unavailable to US citizens or residents; TradeHub remains. Restricted countries follow OFAC-style sanctions (Russia, Iran, DPRK, Syria, Venezuela, Belarus, and others).

What Verodus is trying to do

The operating plan, stripped of marketing: sell cheap simulated evaluations at global scale; fail most buyers against tight risk rules; pay a minority who stay inside drawdown, consistency, and payout gates; keep the brand on the right side of “this is a simulation, rewards are discretionary.” Instant Funding is the acquisition wedge (“from \$49, funded on day one”). 1-Step and 2-Step Lite/Pro are the classic challenge funnel. The dashboard, mobile app, Rise/crypto payouts, and withdrawal certificates are the trust layer.

Stated scale as of the homepage: +3,000 users, 175+ countries, up to 90% split, \$1M max capital. Household cap in Terms is USD 400,000 of allocated simulated capital. Industry context: Track360's 2026 retail-prop estimate is on the order of USD 850 million revenue and 12 million challenge purchases, with the top five firms taking most acquisition. At 3,000 users Verodus is an early operator, not a category leader. That is the exposure problem.

Product and rules (as published, August 2026)

Program	How you get in	Risk gates	Payout gates
Instant	Pay and trade. No profit target. Sizes \$5k–\$100k.	3% daily from that day's equity high; 6% trailing max that never locks.	Best Day $\leq 20\%$ of Positive Days' Profit. \$100 min. Instant fees not refunded.
1-Step	10% profit target. No min trading days. Up to \$200k.	4% daily; 6% hybrid max (trails, then locks at initial balance).	Best Day $\leq 50\%$. First payout refunds the challenge fee.
2-Step Lite	8% then 5%. 5 trading days per phase. Static 8% max, 4% daily. Leverage 1:100 FX.	Static floor (example: \$100k cannot go below \$92k).	3 trading days in Qualified Performance. Fee refund on first payout.
2-Step Pro	Two-phase evaluation (site lists as a separate SKU alongside Lite).	Published on the objectives / Pro pages; same payout-cycle add-ons.	Same 70/80/90% weekly / bi-weekly / on-demand structure.

Shared plumbing: unlimited time, 30-day inactivity kill, Friday flatten 22:00 UTC (weekend holding is an add-on), news trading allowed but news-bracketing / gap holds banned, EAs allowed except HFT, latency arb, mass-distributed copy EAs, and >2,000 server requests/day. KYC via a third party (Veriff is named in FAQs) before Qualified Performance. Rewards via Rise (bank, local rails, crypto) or wallet. Default split 80%; 90% with On-Demand add-on; 70% weekly add-on.

Legal character of payouts: Terms say performance rewards are discretionary and are not liabilities of the FZ company. That is the model that keeps this a service business rather than an investment contract — and the clause counterparties and regulators will read first.

How the money actually works

Gross profit is evaluation / Instant fees, resets, and add-ons (weekend holding, payout-speed splits). Cost is payouts, payment processing, chargebacks, MT5/TradeHub infra, KYC, support, and acquisition. Instant is the high-margin SKU: no fee refund, tighter trailing drawdown that never locks, and a 20% Best Day rule that delays payouts even after a lucky day. 1-Step / 2-Step refund the challenge fee on first successful payout, so those SKUs only pay if most buyers never reach a clean payout.

This is why “make traders better” is not automatically good for Verodus. A higher pass rate without a matching jump in volume or a new cash line (data license, education add-on, white-label GMV) transfers margin to payouts. Volume at the current rule set is the growth that fits the P&L.

Revenue lever	What it is	Strategic note
Challenge / Instant fees	One-time, non-refundable once trading starts.	Core. Protect fail rate. Grow units.
Add-ons	Weekend holding, weekly 70%, on-demand 90%.	High margin. Do not hide them; price them.
Funded profit share	10–30% of simulated profit after gates.	Secondary. Real only if survivors last.
Data (latent)	Anonymized CRM behavioral / lifecycle labels.	Not live. Privacy policy currently forbids external commercialization.
White-label / affiliate	Other brands originate flow onto Verodus rails.	Best path to Asia exposure without raising pass rates.

The data asset

The CRM already produces what most “AI trading” shops cannot buy: labeled sequences of how retail traders pass, fail, and blow up under known rules (sizing volatility, news-window flags, best-day concentration, time-to-breach, evaluation vs later survival). About-page language already says activity is for performance evaluation and behavioral analysis.

Constraint: the 21 February 2026 Privacy Policy says Verodus does not commercialize or exploit user trading strategies externally, and that trader P&L / behavior data is shared internally only. “The CRM vendor allows resale” does not override that. Anonymized aggregates and irreversible feature tables can be licensed after a policy amendment, DPA, and counsel memo. PII, KYC, wallets, IPs, and copy-tradable tickets should not be sold. That is the same gate used in the MoniMath analysis.

Competitive position

Category: retail simulated prop, 2026. Competitors (FTMO, FundedNext, The5ers, E8, Apex, Topstep) compete on price, payout speed, Trustpilot volume, affiliate armies, and whether traders believe payouts actually land. Verodus’s differentiation on paper is clarity (rules on the site, not only in a PDF), Instant as a lead SKU, free trials with no cap stated, dual platforms from one account, and unusually explicit “this is simulated / discretionary” legal copy — a lesson from CFTC v. MyForexFunds-style enforcement.

Gaps versus leaders: user count, independent review density, named banking/free-zone footprint, and US MT5 access. Instant trailing-never-locks plus 20% Best Day is trader-hostile relative to looser Instant shops; that is good for P&L and bad for YouTube affiliates unless payouts are visibly real.

What looks strong

- Product is real: published rule pages dated August 2026, dashboard, two platforms, KYC, Rise/crypto, inactivity and household caps, prohibited-practice taxonomy.
- Legal posture is more careful than typical prop marketing: simulation disclaimers on Instant/1-Step/2-Step pages; FAQ “is Verodus legitimate?” answers the model honestly; rewards

called discretionary.

- Instant + Best Day + trailing drawdown is a coherent fail-heavy machine, not an accident.
- Data exhaust is scarce and valuable if licensed without leaking edge or PII.
- Global payment and sanctions list exist; US is handled by dropping MT5 rather than pretending.

What to consider / fix

1. Entity hygiene. Align Privacy (Verodus LLC), Terms (Verodus L.L.C.-FZ), payments (Verodus Capital Inc.), and Risk Disclosure. Publish free-zone, license activity, and a service address. Counterparties (MoniMath, Rise, MetaQuotes, banks) will ask.
2. Trustpilot. Homepage says 4.5/5. An independent, loadable review profile was not confirmed in this research; third-party snippets conflict. Either claim a live Trustpilot URL with a real score, or drop the number. Review inflation is how this category gets punished in public.
3. Copy drift. Blog "best simulated prop firm 2026" still describes 10%/5% targets and 10%/5% drawdowns that do not match live Instant/1-Step/Lite pages. Homepage hero "from \$49" vs Instant table (\$72 struck from \$110 on the \$5k tier, and \$100k Instant at \$399/\$614). Payout carousel repeats \$9,401.23 for both "Jose" and "Joe" in the US. Traders screenshot this.
4. Certificate authenticity. If withdrawal certificates are real, make the unique ID verifiable. Duplicate round numbers on the homepage look generated.
5. Privacy vs data strategy. Do not sell behavioral data under the current policy. Amend first: anonymized research license yes; strategy replication no.
6. Scale without destroying the model. Growth should be more buyers at current rules (affiliates, Asia white-label, SEO) not easier rules. Education only as a paid add-on.
7. MetaQuotes / US. Platform 5 blocked for US persons is correct and fragile. Have a written fallback if MT5 prop access tightens further.
8. Discretionary payouts vs brand. The clause protects you; slow or opaque payouts kill affiliates. Publish a monthly payout total or certificate verifier.
9. Founder surface area. Kim Chen and Alexander Vladimirovich have titles and almost no public bios. For a 3,000-user shop that is fine; for banking, listing, or a Hong Kong partner it is a gap.
10. SEO farms. Third-party posts (content-mill style) already recycle Verodus copy. Own the narrative or those pages will define you in search.

Strategic recommendations

If the goals are exposure and financial profit, in this order:

1. Keep Instant as the paid front door. Do not loosen the 6% never-lock trail or 20% Best Day to win affiliate YouTube. Show payouts instead.
2. Buy distribution, do not donate data. Affiliates and white-label (including a paid MoniMath origination deal) add fail-heavy volume. Data is a separate cash SKU after counsel updates the privacy policy.
3. Fix public consistency this month: entity names, Trustpilot, pricing hero vs table, blog vs live rules, duplicate certificate amounts.
4. Productize the CRM: anonymized benchmark reports, partner API, optional coaching add-on. That is high-margin and does not require raising pass rates.
5. Treat 3,000 users as a data moat in training, not as a finished market. The firm that reaches 30,000–50,000 evaluations with the same risk engine has a sellable behavior dataset and a

real affiliate story. The firm that stays at 3,000 with messy Trustpilot copy does not.

Bottom line

Verodus is a real, small, legally cautious simulated-evaluation business whose P&L depends on people buying challenges and mostly not getting paid. That is a valid service model if disclosures stay honest and payouts that do go out are visible. The upside is volume plus a later data license. The downside is looking like every other Instant shop with unverifiable social proof. Fix the public inconsistencies, do not loosen rules for "exposure," and only sell anonymized data after the privacy policy says you can.

Sources: verodus.com (home, about, Instant, 1-Step, 2-Step Lite, trading objectives, FAQ, Terms, Privacy 21 Feb 2026, Risk Disclosure, Responsible Trading, blog). Industry context: Track360 2026 retail-prop estimates. This is an internal commercial memo from public materials, not an audit and not legal advice.